*BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER*
*ROBINS AIR FORCE BASE*

*ROBINS AIR FORCE BASE*
*INSTRUCTION 48-131*

*10 JULY 2020*

*Aerospace Medicine*

*ANIMAL CONTROL*

**COMPLIANCE WITH THIS INSTRUCTION IS MANDATORY**

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This instruction aligns with Air Force Publishing Directive (AFPD) 48-1, *Aerospace Medicine*, and implements Armed Force Joint Instruction (AFJI) 48-131, *Veterinary Health Services*. It establishes and defines procedures and responsibilities for controlling pets on Robins Air Force Base (AFB). It applies to all persons transporting or having an animal under their control on Robins AFB and establishes responsibilities for Privatized Housing (PH) residents, 78th Security Forces Squadron (78 SFS), US Army Veterinary Services, and 78th Civil Engineer Group (78 CEG). This publication may be supplemented at any level. Refer recommended changes, supplements, and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using Air Force (AF) Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication;* route AF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. Requests for waivers must come through the chain of command from the commander of the office seeking relief from compliance. Waiver requests must be submitted to the OPR; waiver authority has not been delegated. The waiver approval authority for all compliance items within this publication are at Wing Level (Tier T-3). Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with (IAW) AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of IAW the AF Records Information Management System Records Disposition Schedule located at **https://www.my.af.mil/afrims/afrims/afrims/rds/rds_series.cfm**. See **Attachment 1** for a glossary of references and supporting information.

*SUMMARY OF CHANGES*

This document is substantially revised and must be completely reviewed. It aligns the US Army Veterinary Treatment Facility under the 78 Medical Group (78 MDG/CC).

## 1. Procedures.

1.1. No more than two pets per household (or family) may be kept in the PH areas of Robins AFB. Requests for exceptions to this policy will be submitted, in writing to 78 CEG/CEIH (PH). The only exception to this will be a litter of puppies or kittens. They will be allowed to remain on the premises for a period of not more than 10 weeks after their birth to allow for weaning and disposition. Pit bulls (including American Staffordshire Bull Terriers or English Staffordshire Bull Terriers), Rottweilers, Doberman Pinschers, Chows, and wolf hybrids are breeds of dogs that are prohibited on Robins AFB. Exotic pets such as snakes, skunks, raccoons, foxes, coyotes, wolves, bats, alligators, and primates are strictly prohibited on Robins AFB. Domestic farm animals such as cattle, potbelly pigs, and chickens are prohibited on Robins AFB.

1.1.1. A person desiring to ride a horse on any part of Robins AFB other than the area designated by 78 FSS/SSCO must contact 78 FSS/SSCO for permission (riders will be responsible for removal of feces).

1.2. The following conditions apply to personnel keeping pets in PH:

1.2.1. Registration. Register dogs, cats and ferrets when they are immunized (meet vaccination age), or within two weeks of arrival on base, and yearly thereafter, triennially for rabies vaccination. To register horses, furnish Coggins test (performed within 30 days), deworming (within 30 days), immunizations (**Attachment 2**), and a health certificate prior to the horses' arrival on base. Failure to maintain current vaccinations on a dog, cat, ferret or horse will be grounds for its removal from Robins AFB and disciplinary action against the owner.

1.2.2. Immunizations. Dog, cat, ferret and horse owners will comply with the health requirements set forth by the US Army Veterinary Services, Robins AFB, at the time of registration. Owners will have dogs, cats, ferrets, and horses immunized and tested for contagious diseases (**Attachment 2**). Failure to comply with this requirement and have animals immunized within the month of their due date will be grounds for the immediate removal of animals from Robins AFB.

1.2.3. Identification. Affix the metal rabies tag issued at the time of immunization to the dog or cat collar. This speeds owner identification and validation of rabies immunization. Failure to comply with these provisions will subject the offender to disciplinary action.

1.2.3.1. Micro chipping of dogs and cats residing on Robins AFB PH is mandatory and can be done at a civilian veterinary clinic or at the Robins Veterinary Treatment Facility.

1.3. Abuse or Neglect. Immediately report cases of animal abuse or neglect to the 78 SFS. The veterinarian will advise the Commander, 78th Air Base Wing (78 ABW/CC) in cases of alleged animal abuse or disregard for proper animal care. Violations include but are not limited to:

1.3.1. Failure to provide adequate living space and appropriate shelter from the elements.

1.3.2. Failure to provide food and water daily.

1.3.3. Abandoning any animal.

1.3.4. Failure on the part of a motor vehicle driver to report to 78 SFS the death or injury of an animal struck by said driver.

1.3.5. Leaving or exposing an animal to any poisonous substance or aiding or soliciting any person to do so.

1.3.6. Leaving an animal unattended in a vehicle.

1.3.7. Failure to maintain clean premises. Remove animal waste from common areas (home, yards, kennels, and outdoor cages) at least daily.

1.4. Abandonment. Owners will not abandon their pets upon departure from this base for any reason. Animals will be placed in the care of a responsible party, or the local Humane Society.

1.5. Removal of pets from Robins AFB for cause:

1.5.1. Pet owners whose pets are involved in any combination of three of the following violations within a 12-month period must remove the pet from Robins AFB. Pets that:

1.5.1.1. Are not controlled (on a leash),

1.5.1.2. Cause unsanitary conditions,

1.5.1.3. Cause destruction of property,

1.5.1.4. Create a disturbance of the peace, or

1.5.1.5. Do not have current immunizations or are not given heartworm preventive according to **paragraphs 1.1.1.2** and **A1.3.3**, respectively.

1.5.2. The owner must immediately remove pets from Robins AFB declared vicious by the 78 ABW/CC and US Army Veterinary Services Clinic. One incident or attack may justify the 78 ABW/CC to declare an animal vicious; however, pets involved in an unprovoked attack, regardless of whether the attack is classified as a scratch or bite, are deemed to have vicious tendencies. The US Army Veterinarian, Commander, 78 SFS/CC, and the Staff Judge Advocate (78 ABW), or their designated representatives, will act as advisors to the 78 ABW/CC to determine whether a pet will be declared vicious. The 78 SFS will investigate all cases of animal bites that take place within the limits of Robins AFB.

1.5.2.1. The 78 ABW/CC will notify pet owners, in writing, to remove their pets from the base. Owners must present written/verbal verification of the pet's removal within 24 hours of that notice.

1.5.3. Animal bites. Pets involved in a bite or scratch incident will report to the US Army Veterinary Services, upon request, with the pet for examination and quarantine instructions. Any pets residing on Robins AFB may be quarantined under the owner's observation in an escape-proof outdoor cage on the owner's premises or in their residence for 10 days. The use of MWD kennels for privately owned or stray animals is prohibited. Pets who are not current on their rabies vaccination will be required to be vaccinated for rabies at the end of the 10 day quarantine. Failure of the owner to comply with immunization guidelines or quarantine procedures directly violates Hunt Military Communities animal policy and can result in the immediate removal of the animal from

Robins AFB. After which, the local animal control organizations will be made aware of the pet's delinquency. Owners will not be able to bring their pets back on Robins AFB till the proper quarantine procedures are completed for 10 days. The owner must show proof of the pet's current rabies immunization, along with other current required immunizations (**Attachment 2**), and bring proof of vaccinations to the Robins Veterinary Treatment Facility before bringing the animal back on the base.

1.6. The feeding and keeping of stray animals is strictly prohibited (except feeding backyard birds). No one will tamper with, move, or damage government-owned capture equipment or traps. No one will trap wild or stray animals other than mice and rats. Do not release captured or trapped animals or tamper with bait.

1.7. The breeding and raising of animals for the purpose of commercial sale is prohibited on Robins AFB. A commercial breeder is an owner who allows an animal to have more than one litter or sells the offspring.

1.8. Transient Animals. Authorized sponsors of a rodeo, circus, pet show, field trial, horse show, or other activity bringing animals on this installation will coordinate with the installation Veterinarian so that entry of infectious animal disease will be prevented. Animals visiting the installation, including trail riding horses, must meet and show proof of the requirements for on base animals set forth in **Attachment 2** of this regulation. Entry of animals not listed in **Attachment 2** will be handled on a case by case basis by the installation Veterinarian. Entry of out of state animals will be denied unless accompanied by a valid health certificate issued by an accredited veterinarian and in accordance with State of Georgia import requirements.

**2. Responsibilities:**

2.1. The 78 SFS/CC will:

2.1.1. Direct phone calls, questions, situations of any animal that has bitten or scratched any person on base to 78 MDG/SGPM or any animal that is suspected of having rabies to 78 CEG/CEOIE.

2.1.2. Direct the picking up and impounding of unregistered or stray animals found on the installation to 78 CEG/CEOSV.

2.2. Owners will:

2.2.1. Ensure their pets are registered and immunized according to this instruction.

2.2.2. Ensure animals kept outside are provided a means to protect themselves from the weather (i.e., doghouse). A doghouse is defined as a shelter with four walls, floor, and roof that would serve to shield the animal from heat, cold, and wet weather conditions. It must be in good repair, painted or stained, and not present an unsightly appearance.

2.2.3. Provide water and shade and prohibit the tethering of animals for any length of time.

2.2.4. Keep dogs in a fenced area if they will spend extended periods outside (two or more consecutive hours). This area should be at least 250 square feet with warning signs visibly posted. Electrical and invisible fences are strictly prohibited. **Note:** This requirement prohibits the tethering of animals for any length of time; and (or) leaving them unattended. This policy will be enforced to reduce the possibility of damage to property and personnel.

2.2.5. Remove feces immediately after defecation in public areas and daily from the animal's confines.

2.2.6. Report all acutely sick or dead animals as soon as possible to the base veterinarian for evaluation of a base threat to human health and other base pets.

2.2.7. Supervise and control pets. Do not allow them to have access to dining halls, cafeterias, clubs, base exchanges, dormitories, center headquarters, medical/dental centers, guest house, recreational sports areas (tennis, golf, bowling, swimming, running tracks and others), places of public assembly (playgrounds, public buildings, theaters and others), or similar places where food is prepared or served. This does not apply to assistance dogs or military working dogs. Do not leave pets unattended in a building where government property may be contaminated or damaged. Do not allow dogs to swim in base lakes, ponds, creeks, or wetlands.

2.2.8. Prevent pets from biting, continuous barking, or other offensive habits that would be regarded as a nuisance.

2.2.9. Be responsible for property or personal damage done by their pets.

2.2.10. Give humane treatment and care to their pets.

2.2.11. Keep dogs on leashes, within enclosure, or within the confines of their residence. Do not hinder walkway to residence or allow access to neighbors' yard. Do not chain or tie pets to trees in the area or otherwise cause an unsightly appearance. Keep cats strictly indoors.

2.2.12. Ensure every effort is made to keep female dogs and cats in heat in the owner's quarters or a secure enclosure in such a manner that the female dog or cat cannot come into contact with other animals.

2.2.13. Ensure trash receptacles are sealed and no trash is left unsecured. Do not place trash bags on the ground beside receptacles.

2.2.14. Ensure no pet food is left outdoors at night.

2.2.15. Ensure pet fish or turtles are not released into the natural environment such as lakes, ponds, or wetlands.

2.3. 78 CEG will:

2.3.1. 78 CEG will dispose of animal carcasses after approval of the US Army Veterinary Services. The 78 SFS will report any dead animal observed to 78 CEG Customer Service, who will ensure the carcass is picked up pick up and disposed of immediately. Disposal of dead pets is the responsibility of the pets' owner unless ownership cannot be determined.

BRIAN MOORE, Colonel, USAF
Commander

## Attachment 1

## GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

***References***

AFMAN 33-363, *Management of Record*s, 1 March 2008

AFPD 48-1, *Aerospace and Operational Medicine Enterprise,* 07 Jun 2019

AFJI 48-131, *Veterinary Health Services,* 26 August 2006

*Georgia Rabies Control Manual*, 6th Ed., May 2012, *Georgia Department of Human Resources*.

***Adopted Forms***

AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

DD Form 2208, *Rabies Vaccination Certificate*

***Abbreviations and Acronyms***

**AF**—Air Force

**AFB**—Air Force Base

**AFJI**—Armed Forces Joint Instruction

**AFMAN**—Air Force Manual

**AFPD**—Air Force Publishing Directive

**AFRIMS**—Air Force Records Information Management System

**OPR**—Office of Primary Responsibility

**PH**—Privatized Family Housing

**RDS**—Records Disposition Schedule

**VTF**—Veterinary Treatment Facility

## Attachment 2

## REGISTRATION AND IMMUNIZATIONS

**A2.1. Registration.** Owners must:

A2.1.1. Register all pets within 5 days of arrival at the Huntington Village office if on base resident. If utilizing off base housing, register your pet with county government through a local Veterinarian Treatment Facility (VTF) or Robins AFB VTF. At the time of registration, the VTF will review and maintain valid health certificates, immunization certificates, medical records, and official laboratory reports. Owners must submit subsequent immunization certificates, medical records, and laboratory reports to the VTF for review and file.

A2.1.2. Securely fastens the metal rabies tag issued at the time of registration to the collar or harness of all pets as a means of identification. Obtain replacement for lost tags and certificates at the VTF.

A2.1.3. Arrange for registration and quarantine of horses through the veterinary liaison of the Robins Riding Club. Quarantine all new horses arriving on base at the quarantine paddocks for a minimum of 14 days. A licensed veterinarian or the NCOIC of the Veterinary Treatment Facility will do an incoming physical of all horses. Only a licensed veterinarian will do quarantine release physicals. Horses will be housed in an area separate from other horses during the quarantine period. Horses arriving together may be quarantined as a group. Restrict riding or exercising of horses during the quarantine period to the quarantine paddock premises.

A2.1.4. A licensed veterinary laboratory tests all horses on base, serologically, for equine infectious anemia (Coggins). Owners will furnish proof that such test was performed not more than 30 days prior to arrival on base. All horses kept on base must be tested annually, and an original copy of the official laboratory Coggins test results will be supplied to the VTF. Immunizations will be current. Deworming will be done 30 days prior to arrival and a health certificate from a licensed veterinarian will be submitted to the VTF prior to unloading the horse off the trailer.

**A2.2. Immunizations.** The only acceptable proof of immunization is a valid health certificate/copy of health record issued by a licensed veterinarian. All pets and horses on this installation will be immunized by a licensed veterinarian, at the owner's expense, according to the following minimum requirements: All vaccine records should be maintained at the Vet Clinic.

A2.2.1. Dogs.

A2.2.1.1. Rabies - Dogs are vaccinated at three months of age or within 5 days of arrival at Robins AFB, revaccinated at one year, and annually or triennially thereafter.

A2.2.1.2. Canine Distemper, Infectious Canine Hepatitis, Leptospirosis, Parainfluenza, and Canine Parvo Virus - All dogs must be adequately immunized against these diseases. All dogs and puppies as young as seven weeks of age must undergo the immunization program with boosters thereafter according to AVMA and US Army Veterinary Medical Standardization Board guidelines.

A2.2.1.3. All dogs will be on heartworm prevention year round. The heart worm prevention used will contain an anthelmintic drug for the control of intestinal parasites. The VTF or a civilian veterinarian will treat dogs that test positive for heartworms. If a civilian veterinarian is used, proof of treatment will be supplied to the Robins AFB VTF. Failure to do so will result in removal of the dog from base.

A2.2.1.4. Intestinal Parasite Exams – All dogs will have a yearly intestinal parasite exam. If positive, the dog will be treated.

A2.2.1.5. External Parasite Control – External parasites such as fleas, mites, ticks, and lice will be controlled as needed.

A2.2.2. Cats.

A2.2.2.1. Rabies - Cats are vaccinated at three months of age and revaccinated annually.

A2.2.2.2. Panleukopenia (feline distemper), Rhinotracheitis, and Calici Virus – Cats and kittens as young as eight weeks of age must undergo the immunization program and be revaccinated according to AVMA and US Army Veterinary Medical Standardization Board guidelines.

A2.2.2.3. Intestinal Parasite Exams – All cats will have a yearly intestinal parasite exam. If positive, the cat will be treated.

A2.2.2.4. External Parasite Control – External parasites such as fleas, mites, ticks, and lice will be controlled as needed.

A2.2.3. Ferrets. All ferrets kept as pets on RAFB are required to be registered on base within two weeks of arrival (**paragraph A1.1.1**).

A2.2.3.1. Rabies – All ferrets are vaccinated at three months of age and revaccinated annually.

A2.2.3.2. FerVac-Distemper - All ferrets over three months of age must undergo the immunization program and be revaccinated according to AVMA and US Army Veterinary Medical Standardization Board guidelines.

A2.2.4. Horses.

A2.2.4.1. All horses arriving on base will be considered unvaccinated for rabies unless a health certificate or vaccination certificate issued by a licensed veterinarian can be provided.

A2.2.4.2. All horses 90 days of age and older must be vaccinated annually (once before the mosquito season) for Eastern and Western Equine Encephalomyelitis, Influenza, and Rhinopneumonitis. Horses at higher risk of exposure may require semiannual vaccination.

A2.2.4.3. All horses over 90 days of age must be vaccinated annually for rabies and tetanus toxoid.

A2.2.4.4. A licensed veterinarian must immunize all horses.

A2.2.4.5. Intestinal Parasite Control – All horses will be treated for intestinal parasites every 8 weeks. Intestinal parasite exams will be performed as needed based on clinical signs, and as a screening tool for herd health.

A2.2.4.6. External Parasite Control – External parasites will be treated or controlled as needed.

## Attachment 3

## POINTS OF CONTACT

**A3.1. Points of Contact.**

A3.1.1. 78 CEG/CEIE. Environmental Management Division can be reached at 468-9645. Natural Resource Manager can be reached after hours at 478-397-7962.

A3.1.2. 78 CEG. The Base Civil Engineer can be reached at 468-3093.

A3.1.3. 78 CEG/CEOIE. Entomology Shop can be reached at 468-2082.

A3.1.4. 78 SFS. Security Forces can be reached at 926-2187.

A3.1.5. Base Operations can be reached at 926-2114.

A3.1.6. US Army Veterinary Treatment Facility can be reached at 497-8448.

A3.1.7. DNR and USDA. 78 CEG/CEIE is responsible for contacting DNR and USDA.

A3.1.8. 78 MDG. Public Health can be reached at 497-8019.